THE AGED LEAD OPERATOR'S SYSTEM

The Mortgage Edition

The complete operator's manual for turning aged mortgage leads into closed deals — scripts, unit economics, cadence, nurture, and compliance.

7.5×

typical ROI at 15% contact × 4% close on aged mortgage leads

Aged Lead Sales · agedleadsales.com
Not legal advice · Consult TCPA-literate counsel before running outreach

The Aged Lead Operator's System

The complete playbook for turning cheap leads into closed deals.

By Bill Rice — Founder, Aged Lead Sales

A note on how to use this playbook

Aged-lead operations run on three compliance modes. Pick the one that matches your risk appetite and your counsel's advice.

Mode A — Conservative. Manual dialing only. SMS only to leads where you have captured fresh consent *directly from the prospect* (not inherited from a publisher). No predictive or parallel dialing, no ringless voicemail. Every touch logged with consent record. The legal floor. Slower velocity, lowest exposure. **Most small shops should start here.**

Mode B — Operator Standard. Manual or preview (one-at-a-time, agent-initiated) dialing. SMS only to leads with clear documented consent that permits SMS from your company. Rigorous DNC scrub, documented opt-out honoring, 10DLC registration. Quarterly compliance audit. What most compliant growth-oriented operators run.

Mode C — Not Recommended. Predictive or parallel dialing to cell phones, ringless voicemail at scale, SMS to aged lists without verified consent, ignoring state mini-TCPA frequency caps. High plaintiff's-firm exposure and regulatory risk. **This playbook does not teach these tactics.**

Default recommendation: start in Mode A. Use the scripts and cadence in this playbook to re-contact aged leads via manual dial and email. Use the "Fresh-Consent Ladder" techniques (Part IV) to *earn fresh SMS and automation consent directly from each prospect* — then you can graduate those specific prospects to Mode B outreach cleanly.

Recommended counsel. If you need a TCPA/compliance attorney, the firm I trust is Henson Legal. They're who I call when I have a real question.

This playbook is operator guidance, not legal advice. TCPA, FCC rules, and state mini-TCPA laws change frequently, and consent requirements vary by state and by consent record. Before running outreach against any list, consult counsel familiar with TCPA and your state's rules. For regulated verticals (mortgage, insurance, Medicare), also consult the applicable CFPB, CMS, DOI, and state-licensing guidance.

Who this is for

You bought aged leads before. Maybe they worked. Maybe they didn't. Either way, something told you there's more to extract from them — and you were right.

This playbook is for the sales professional or small team who is done guessing. You want a system that turns a cold file of 30-, 60-, or 180-day-old leads into predictable, trackable pipeline. You want scripts that don't sound like a call center. You want to know — down to the unit — what it costs to close one.

You don't need theory. You need a playbook you can run on Monday morning.

What's inside

1. **Part I — The Operator's Mindset.** Why aged leads still convert, why most people fail at them, and the three beliefs you need before you pick up the phone.
2. **Part II — The Unit Economics.** The five numbers that decide whether aged leads make or lose you money, and how to calculate your break-even on any list.
3. **Part III — Setting Up Your Operation.** The tech stack spectrum from no-tech to full-tech, and the minimum viable setup for each level.
4. **Part IV — The Outreach Framework.** A day-by-day, channel-by-channel cadence. Scripts included. Rules of engagement for phone, SMS, email, and voicemail.
5. **Part V — The Infinity Nurture System.** How to turn an aged-lead database into a long-term asset that produces closes for years.
6. **Part VI — Compliance Foundation.** TCPA, state DNC, consent documentation, suppression lists. The rules that keep you in business.
7. **Part VII — The 90-Day Operator Diagnostic.** A self-scoring assessment to see exactly where your operation is strong and where it's leaking money.

Your **workbook** is the companion to this playbook. It has 10 worksheets that turn every framework here into a filled-out artifact for your business. Work the playbook and the workbook together.

Part I — The Operator's Mindset

Why aged leads still convert

Aged leads are consumer inquiries — mortgage, insurance, home services, whatever vertical you work — that were generated 30, 60, 90, or 180+ days ago. They filled out a form or made a call. They got worked by the original buyer. Then they went into a file and got re-sold at a steep discount.

The conventional wisdom is that they're "dead." That's wrong, and it's wrong for a specific, measurable reason: **consumer intent doesn't evaporate on a schedule that matches a call center's patience.**

A homeowner who asked about refinancing in January didn't stop needing money in February. A small business owner who requested insurance quotes in March didn't magically find coverage in April. What changed is that the agent on the other end called them three times, got voicemail, and quit.

The aged-leads opportunity is arbitrage on sales-team attention span.

The data supports this. Across the aged-leads industry, a well-run campaign will produce:

- **12–18% contact rate** over a multi-touch, multi-channel cadence
- **1–5% contact-to-close** conversion rate, depending on vertical and skill
- **$5–$25 cost per contact** at typical aged-lead prices
- **$50–$500+ cost per close** depending on deal size and vertical

Run those numbers against a $300 commission or a $5,000 loan margin, and you have a business. Run them against a $50 final-expense premium or a $150 roofing lead, and you have a business. The numbers work in almost every vertical — if, and only if, you run them like an operator.

Why most people fail at aged leads

I've watched hundreds of buyers try aged leads. The ones who fail have one of four problems:

1. **They treat aged like fresh.** They expect the same answer-rate as a lead generated 30 seconds ago. When they don't get it, they quit.

2. **They don't have a cadence.** They call once, maybe leave a voicemail, maybe send a text, and move on. Aged leads reward persistence. Single-touch aged is a waste of money.
3. **They skip the math.** They don't know their cost-per-contact, so they don't know if they're winning or losing. They judge by feel. Feel is a liar.
4. **They cut compliance corners.** They skip DNC scrubbing, they text without consent, they get a cease-and-desist, they panic, they quit the channel. Compliance isn't a tax — it's a moat.

All four problems are solvable. That's what this playbook fixes.

> **Where to buy the leads in this playbook.**
>
> Before you read further: you'll need actual aged leads to run this system. The largest, cleanest-consent marketplace in the industry is **AgedLeadStore** — vertical-specific lists, documented consent records, and filter by age/geo/demographics.
>
> **Browse all lead types at agedleadstore.com →**

The three beliefs you need

Before we get into tactics, adopt these three beliefs. If you can't get behind them, close this file and ask for a refund.

Belief 1: Volume beats velocity.

Fresh-lead sales is a velocity game. Aged-lead sales is a volume game. You are not trying to convert every lead as fast as possible. You are trying to touch the largest number of leads enough times to surface the ones who still have intent. A 1% close rate on 2,000 leads is 20 deals. A 5% close rate on 100 leads is 5 deals. The 2,000-lead operator wins.

Belief 2: The follow-up is the product.

Your product isn't the call. Your product isn't the quote. Your product is a **sustained, professional presence** in the prospect's inbox, phone, and calendar over a 30-, 60-, 90-day window. If you show up on Day 1 and quit on Day 3, you are not running aged leads. You are running a lottery.

Belief 3: Compliance is a weapon, not a cost.

Every competitor who skips DNC, ignores state consent laws, or fires off blind autodialed SMS is going to get shut down. You get to eat their leads, their prospects, and their market share — on the one condition that you stay clean. Compliance is not a tax you pay to lawyers. It is the floor that lets you build higher than the operators who chose shortcuts.

Part II — The Unit Economics

Every aged-lead operation lives or dies by five numbers. Most people know two of them. The winners know all five and track them weekly.

The five numbers

1. Cost Per Lead (CPL)

What you paid to acquire the lead file. Aged leads typically run:

Age	Vertical avg CPL
30–60 days	$3–$10
61–90 days	$1–$5
91–180 days	$0.50–$2
181+ days	$0.25–$1

Prices vary by vertical (final-expense is cheaper than refi, solar is pricier than auto insurance) and by exclusivity (non-exclusive is cheaper than exclusive).

2. Contact Rate

The percentage of leads you actually reach (human answering the phone, replying to text, or replying to email). Industry benchmarks for a well-run, multi-touch, 7–14-day cadence:

Data age	Realistic contact rate
30–60 days	18–25%
61–90 days	14–20%
91–180 days	10–16%
181+ days	6–12%

If you're hitting the low end, your phone numbers are old, your cadence is thin, or your channel mix is wrong. The playbook fixes all three.

3. Contact-to-Close Rate

Of the contacts you reach, what percentage turn into a sale, application, or booked job. This is the number that's most under your control. Typical ranges:

Vertical	Contact-to-close
Mortgage (refi/purchase)	2–6%
Final expense	8–15%
Auto insurance	3–8%
Home services	5–12%
Solar	2–5%
Medicare	4–10%

Your scripts, your product, your price, and your pipeline follow-up all move this number.

4. Average Revenue Per Close (ARPC)

What you earn per closed deal. Commission, override, net margin — whatever flows to you personally or your business.

5. Cost Per Close (CPC)

This is the output number. It's the ratio that decides if the operation makes money.

```
CPC = CPL ÷ (Contact Rate × Contact-to-Close Rate)
```

If your CPL is $2, your contact rate is 15%, and your contact-to-close is 4%:

```
CPC = $2 ÷ (0.15 × 0.04) = $2 ÷ 0.006 = $333
```

You are paying $333 in lead cost for every closed deal. If your ARPC is $1,200, you have a $867 gross contribution per close. If your ARPC is $300, you're losing $33 every time you win — and the operation is upside-down.

The break-even math

Your break-even ARPC is the ARPC you *must* hit to cover your CPC.

```
Break-even ARPC = CPL ÷ (Contact Rate × Contact-to-Close Rate)
```

That's literally the same formula as CPC. Your break-even ARPC is your CPC.

If your ARPC is below your CPC, you have two options: reduce CPL (buy older or larger batches), or raise contact rate and contact-to-close (better cadence, better scripts). This playbook gives you both levers.

The profitability gate

Before you buy a single lead, run the pre-flight check:

1. **What's your ARPC?** Be honest. Use the average of your last 10 closes, not your best one.
2. **What's your realistic contact rate?** If you're new to aged, assume 12%. If you've run a few batches, use your actual number.
3. **What's your realistic contact-to-close?** If you're new to aged, assume 2%. If you've run a few batches, use your actual number.
4. **Compute max viable CPL:** `Max CPL = ARPC × 0.25 × Contact Rate × Contact-to-Close`

The `× 0.25` gives you a 4× return on lead spend. That's the minimum you want — it covers labor, overhead, and leaves margin. If you want a 5× return, use `× 0.20`. If you want to break even, use `× 1.00`.

Example. You sell auto insurance with an ARPC of $250. You target a 4× return. You estimate 15% contact rate, 5% contact-to-close.

```
Max CPL = $250 × 0.25 × 0.15 × 0.05 = $0.47
```

You should not pay more than $0.47 per lead. If someone is selling you aged auto-insurance leads at $3, they are selling you a losing operation no matter how good your scripts are.

This one calculation, done before purchase, filters out 80% of the bad deals in the aged-leads market.

Worksheet 1 — Unit Economics. In your companion workbook, fill out the unit-economics worksheet with your actual numbers. It takes 10 minutes. Do not skip it.

Part III — Setting Up Your Operation

You don't need a $50K tech stack to run aged leads. You don't even need a CRM. What you need is a system — a defined flow from lead arrival to close, with an owner for each step.

This section lays out three setups: no-tech, light-tech, and full-tech. Pick the one that matches your volume and scale up only when you hit a bottleneck.

The three setups

Setup A: No-tech (1 rep, 0–500 leads/month)

You can run this with a phone, a cheap SMS service, and a spreadsheet. You will not scale past 500 leads per month, but you will have a working operation inside of a week.

Required:

- Dialer: any business phone line, VoIP preferred (Google Voice, OpenPhone, $15/mo)
- SMS: compliant texting tool ($20–$50/mo — TextMagic, Textline, SimpleTexting)
- Email: Gmail/Outlook + a free tracking extension (Mailtrack)
- DNC scrubber: DNC.com, PossibleNOW, or NCOA + DNC tool ($50–$200 per scrub)
- CRM: **None.** Use a Google Sheet with columns for lead source, date purchased, phone, email, last-touch date, status, notes, next-action date.

What you give up: dialer analytics, automated cadence, call recording for QA, reporting beyond what you can calculate in the sheet.

What you keep: 100% of your margin and a working operation.

Setup B: Light-tech (1–5 reps, 500–5,000 leads/month)

You've outgrown the sheet. You're missing follow-ups. You're losing track of what you said to whom. You need infrastructure.

Required:

- Dialer: a business phone system with call recording ($50–$100/user/month — Kixie, Aircall, RingCentral)

- SMS: integrated with the CRM ($0.01–$0.03 per message typically bundled with the CRM)
- Email: business inbox integrated with the CRM
- DNC scrubber: integrated or batch ($100–$500/month at volume)
- CRM: a real CRM with cadence automation (HubSpot, Close, Zoho, GoHighLevel — $50–$150/user/month)
- **Preview dialer only** — agent sees the record and initiates each call one-at-a-time ($75–$150/user/month — PhoneBurner preview mode, Kixie PowerList preview mode). **Do not use parallel or predictive dialing modes on aged cell-phone leads.** The TCPA consent picture on inherited aged-lead consent rarely supports auto-initiated dialing to cell phones without exposure; predictive/parallel dialers are a Mode C tactic in this context.

What you gain: cadence automation (touches fire automatically per your rules), call recording for training and QA, pipeline visibility, contact-rate tracking per list source so you can buy smarter.

Total cost (1 rep): $200–$400/month. At 1,000 leads/month, that's $0.20–$0.40 added cost per lead — meaningful, but usually recovered 5× over in productivity gains.

Setup C: Full-tech (5+ reps, 5,000+ leads/month)

You're running a real floor. You need scale, predictability, and training infrastructure.

Required everything above, plus:

- AI-assisted dialer / omni-channel platform (Convoso, Five9, Balto, $100–$200/user/month) — **still run in preview mode by default.** Predictive modes are only appropriate if your consent workflow produces fresh PEWC from each prospect before the call (see Fresh-Consent Ladder, Part IV).
- Real-time QA and coaching (Gong, Chorus, Balto AI coaching)
- Inbound call handling for callbacks (dedicated DID pool, skill-based routing)
- Business intelligence layer (Tableau, PowerBI, or custom — $200+/month)
- Compliance automation — TCPA consent capture (inbound opt-ins logged with timestamp/IP), DNC scrub automation, suppression file automation, cross-channel opt-out propagation. At this tier this should be a named system, not an afterthought.

Total cost: $500–$1,200/user/month. This tier is only worth it when you can keep 5+ reps dialing full-time. Below that, you are paying for capacity you aren't using.

Picking your tier — the decision rule

- **Under 500 leads/month and under $5K in gross profit from aged:** stay on Setup A. The tech cost will eat your margin.
- **500–5,000 leads/month and $5K–$30K/month gross profit:** move to Setup B. The automation will more than pay for itself in missed follow-ups recovered.
- **5,000+ leads/month and 3+ full-time reps:** move to Setup C only when the bottleneck is team throughput, not lead quality or scripts.

The two most common mistakes:

1. **Buying Setup C when you only need Setup A.** You spend $5,000/month on tech and your single rep uses 10% of it. The tech is an identity purchase, not a productivity purchase.
2. **Staying on Setup A when you need Setup B.** You have 3 reps sharing a spreadsheet, missing 40% of follow-ups, and you can't explain why your contact rate is terrible. You're saving $400/month in tech and losing $4,000/month in uncalled prospects.

> **Worksheet 2 — Tech Stack Decision.** In your workbook, walk through the decision rule with your current volume and team size. Write down your tier and a 90-day upgrade trigger.

Operational roles (even if one person wears all the hats)

No matter which tier you run, five roles must exist. One person can wear all five — but if any role is missing, the operation leaks.

1. **Buyer.** Sources lead files, negotiates pricing, owns quality tracking per source.
2. **Scrubber.** Runs DNC, state DNC, suppression, and data-hygiene steps before any outreach fires.
3. **Opener.** Runs first-touch outreach (day 0–2), qualifies intent.
4. **Closer.** Handles the quote, application, or sale. May be the same person as opener.
5. **Nurturer.** Owns the 30-, 60-, 90-, 180-day follow-up of everyone who didn't close immediately.

In Setup A, you are all five. That's fine — but block your calendar so each role gets dedicated time. One hour of buying, one hour of scrubbing, four hours of opening, two hours of closing, one hour of nurture, every day. Do not blend them.

Part IV — The Outreach Framework

This is the core of the playbook. Everything else supports this.

The principles

Before the cadence, the principles. Break these and the cadence won't save you.

1. **Multi-channel beats multi-touch on one channel.** Five phone calls is a worse strategy than two phone calls + one voicemail + one SMS + one email. Channels unlock channels.
2. **Different times, different days.** Rotate call times. A prospect who doesn't answer at 10 AM Monday might answer at 6 PM Thursday. Same with SMS send times.
3. **Value in every touch.** Every message — call, voicemail, SMS, email — gives the prospect a reason to respond. Not "just checking in." Ever.
4. **Escalate, then de-escalate.** Front-load intensity in the first 7 days. Taper to weekly, then monthly. Never go to zero.
5. **Document everything.** Every touch logged with outcome. If you can't see the touch history at a glance, the next touch is guessing.

The 14-day opener cadence

This is the cadence for a newly-acquired aged lead, whether it's 30 days old or 180 days old. Run this for every lead. The worksheet in your workbook has a fillable version.

Day 0 (purchase day)

- **Scrub.** Run DNC. Remove suppressed numbers. Remove any state-regulated numbers your licensing doesn't cover.
- **Segment.** Tag by age, source, vertical, and any demographic signal the file provides (geo, age bracket, estimated income).
- **No outreach today.** Give the data 24 hours to finish processing.

Day 1

- **Phone call #1** — morning hours (9–11 AM prospect local time). Use Script A1 (see Part IV scripts).
- If no answer: **voicemail** — 15-second message, value-first, no pressure.
- **SMS #1** — within 15 minutes of the voicemail, referencing the call. "Hey [Name] — Bill with [Company] — just tried you. Quick question on your [vertical] inquiry. Good to grab 2 minutes this week?"

Day 2

- **Email #1** — sent morning. Subject: "Your [vertical] request from [month]." Body: 4–6 lines. Acknowledge the age of the inquiry, offer a specific value point, ask for a time.

Day 3

- **Phone call #2** — different time of day than Day 1 (try afternoon, 2–5 PM local).
- Voicemail only if Call #2 lands on a different day of week than Call #1's voicemail.
- **SMS #2** — value-focused, not follow-up focused. Example: "Hey [Name] — one thing a lot of folks in your situation don't know: [insert value nugget]. Worth a 5-min call?"

Day 5

- **Phone call #3** — third different time (try evening, 5–7 PM local, where compliance allows).
- **Email #2** — different angle. Not "just following up." Case study, stat, or a specific question.

Day 7

- **Phone call #4** — morning, different day of week than all previous.
- **SMS #3** — "break-up" style. "Hey [Name] — I've reached out a couple times on your [vertical] inquiry. If the timing's off, just reply STOP and I'll take you off my list. Otherwise, happy to help when you're ready."

Day 10

- **Email #3** — break-up email. Short. "Closing your file unless I hear back."

Day 14

- **Phone call #5** — final opener-cadence touch. If no contact, move the lead to **nurture** (Part V).

Contact outcomes

If at any point the prospect replies, answers, or otherwise engages: exit the opener cadence, run the qualifying call, and begin the appropriate sales sequence. Do not keep running opener touches on a live prospect.

If at any point the prospect says "stop," "remove me," "not interested," or any cease language: stop all outreach, tag the lead with a suppression flag, add to your internal DNC, and do not touch again.

The phone scripts

Script A1 — First-touch call (live pickup)

> "Hey [Name], this is [Your Name] with [Company]. About [time period] back you asked about [vertical] — is that still something you're exploring, or did you get that handled already?"

Shut up. Wait for the answer. Three outcomes:

- **"Got it handled."** Probe: "Gotcha — totally fine. Mind if I ask what you ended up doing? Just curious, since it'll help me be more useful to folks in a similar spot." Often the answer is "I didn't actually do anything" — and the conversation starts.
- **"Still looking."** Go directly to qualification: "Awesome — quick question: what's the most important thing for you right now on the [vertical] side?" Then run your normal qualifying call.
- **"Who is this, how'd you get my info?"** Direct, calm: "Totally fair question. You filled out a form about [vertical] on [month]. I bought that list from the publisher — that's where your info came from. Happy to take you off my list if the timing's wrong." This kills adversarial energy.

Script A2 — Voicemail (first-touch)

Keep it under 15 seconds. Three elements: who, what, next step.

> "Hey [Name] — [Your Name] with [Company]. Calling about the [vertical] thing you looked at a couple months back. Wanted to see if you still needed help or if you're all set. Give me a ring back at [number] or I'll try you in a couple days."

No urgency, no fake urgency. Aged prospects have been called by 20 people who faked urgency. Calmness cuts through.

Script A3 — Day 3 follow-up call (live pickup)

> "Hey [Name], [Your Name] again with [Company]. Left you a message the other day on your [vertical] question — did that make sense, or do you want me to catch you up on it?"

This script assumes they heard the first voicemail. Most didn't. That's fine — the "did that make sense" framing lets them ask what you're calling about without feeling rude.

Script A4 — Break-up call (Day 7 or Day 14)

> "Hey [Name], [Your Name] with [Company]. I've tried you a few times on your [vertical] inquiry — I'll stop calling after today. If it's just bad timing, no problem, give me a ring when you're ready. My number's [number]. Have a good one."

The break-up pattern works because it removes pressure. Prospects who were avoiding because they thought they'd have to say no now have permission to call back without committing. You'll get a 5–15% callback rate on break-ups when they're done calmly.

The SMS scripts

SMS is the highest-ROI channel in aged-lead outreach when used correctly. It is also the fastest way to lose your operation if you don't get consent and compliance right.

Before sending any SMS, verify:

- The lead's original form had SMS/text consent language
- Your outbound number is registered (for US, this means 10DLC registration with your carrier)
- You're not texting a number on DNC
- Your message includes opt-out language on the first touch ("Reply STOP to unsubscribe")

Script S1 — Post-voicemail SMS

> "Hey [Name] — [Your Name] with [Company] — just left you a voicemail about your [vertical] question from [month]. Got 2 minutes sometime this week? Reply STOP to opt out."

Script S2 — Value-first SMS

> "Hey [Name] — quick thing on [vertical]: [one-sentence value point specific to vertical]. If useful, happy to walk you through it in a 5-min call. Reply STOP to opt out."

Example value points:

- Mortgage: "rates on 30-year fixed dropped ~0.4% this quarter — may be worth a quick look at your numbers"
- Insurance: "most folks I talk to who shopped 3+ months ago are overpaying 15–30% on their current policy"
- Home services: "I'm in your area next week — can do a 15-min no-pressure estimate if you're still thinking about it"

Script S3 — Break-up SMS

> "Hey [Name] — reached out a couple times on your [vertical] question. If the timing's off I'll back off. Reply back if you want to pick it up — otherwise I'll close out my notes. Reply STOP to opt out."

The email scripts

Email is the lowest-intensity channel and the best for long nurture. Opener emails should be short, text-only, and human-toned. No HTML templates. No logos. No "this email was sent by [marketing tool]."

Script E1 — Day 2 opener email

Subject: Your [vertical] request from [month]

> Hey [Name],
>
> Bill here — a few months back, you asked about [vertical] through [source form / publisher name, if you can get it]. I just bought that inquiry list, so your name landed on my desk.
>
> Quick question: did you end up getting that handled, or is it still open?
>
> If it's still open, I can probably save you some time. If it's handled, no worries — just say "handled" and I'll close it out.
>
> — Bill [phone number] [reply-to email]

Script E2 — Day 5 value email

Subject: [One specific question about vertical]

> [Name] —
>
> One thing I see a lot with folks who shopped [vertical] a few months back: [specific pattern or mistake common in that vertical].
>
> If that sounds familiar, I can walk through what's changed in the market since then in about 5 minutes. No pitch — just a quick pulse check.
>
> Want me to send a calendar link, or easier to grab a quick call?
>
> — Bill

Script E3 — Day 10 break-up email

Subject: Closing your file

> [Name] —
>
> I'll stop reaching out after this one. If you want to pick up the [vertical] conversation, just reply here and I'll jump back in. Otherwise, I'll assume the timing's off and close your file on my side.
>
> — Bill

Break-up emails get the highest reply rate of any email in the cadence. Plan for it.

The Fresh-Consent Ladder

Here's the most important operational shift in modern aged-lead work: **your long-term operation shouldn't run on inherited consent at all. It should run on fresh consent that you captured directly from each prospect.**

Inherited consent — the signature the prospect gave a publisher 90 or 180 days ago — is legally murky and getting murkier. Fresh consent — the opt-in you capture from the prospect *today*, naming your company, specifying the channel, with a timestamp and IP — is clean, defensible, and stacks up as an asset over time.

The ladder works like this: use the aged-lead cadence (manual calls, human voicemails, plain-text emails) to **re-open the conversation.** Then, at every moment where the prospect engages, **earn fresh consent** before escalating channels or frequency.

Play 1 — The callback-page opt-in

Every voicemail and email in your cadence sends the prospect to a dedicated landing page (your domain, not the publisher's) that restates the conversation and offers value. The page has a short form: name, phone, email, and an explicit checkbox: *"Yes — please call, text, or email me about my [vertical] question. I understand this consent is given to [Your Company Name]."* Submission logs timestamp, IP, and consent language.

Now that prospect is on your PEWC record. Everything after that — SMS, calendar links, follow-up calls — runs on consent *you captured,* not consent you inherited.

Play 2 — The text-to-join keyword

Build a dedicated SMS keyword: *"Text INFO to [short code or 10DLC number] for a free quote / update / estimate."* Mention it in every voicemail, every email footer, every website page. When the prospect texts in, the reply includes your PEWC disclosure and asks them to confirm: *"Reply YES to continue receiving updates from [Company]. Msg & data rates apply. Reply STOP to cancel."*

When they reply YES, you have fresh, text-initiated, PEWC-compliant SMS consent from the prospect themselves.

Play 3 — The qualifying-call consent ask

At the end of every live qualifying call, before you hang up, ask:

> "Before I let you go — so I can stay in touch as [rates move / your claim progresses / spots open up], can I have your permission to text you? You can reply STOP any time."

Document their verbal yes in the call recording (if you record) or in your CRM note with date/time. This is fresh verbal consent, and in most jurisdictions it supports follow-up SMS and calls from that point forward. Some operators follow this with a quick confirmation text the prospect must reply to — belt and suspenders.

Play 4 — The quote/estimate checkbox

Any time you deliver a quote (mortgage rate quote, insurance illustration, home-services estimate), include a checkbox on the delivery email or form: *"Yes — please text me updates about this [quote / policy / project]."* This is the highest-quality consent you can capture, because the prospect is already deep in the sales funnel.

Play 5 — The nurture re-engagement button

Every newsletter or nurture email to your aged-lead list includes a CTA: *"Still want updates? [Confirm here]"* Prospects who click affirm ongoing consent; prospects who don't silently downgrade to Dormant. Over 6–12 months of nurture, this produces a clean re-consented list that's yours.

Play 6 — The incentive opt-in

Offer something worth opting in for: a market report, a free consultation, a calculator result, a sample estimate. The prospect gives you fresh PEWC in exchange for the resource. You now have permission plus a reason they remember you.

The operational consequence

Once you run the Fresh-Consent Ladder for 60–90 days, your outreach list splits into two tiers:

1. **Tier 1 — Fresh Consent.** Prospects who came back to you and opted in directly. You can run SMS, automation, and broader outreach to them (respecting all legal caps). Treat like a customer list.
2. **Tier 2 — Inherited Consent Only.** Prospects who haven't re-engaged. Mode A outreach only — manual dial, plain-text email, voicemail. No SMS, no automation, no RVM.

The goal of every aged-lead campaign is to move prospects from Tier 2 to Tier 1. The system isn't "work aged leads forever." The system is **convert purchased prospects into owned prospects.**

Worksheet 5 addendum. In your workbook, note which Fresh-Consent Ladder play you'll build first. Start with Play 1 (callback-page opt-in) — it's the highest-leverage one.

You now have the scripts. Get the leads.

The scripts above work on aged leads across mortgage, insurance, solar, home services, Medicare, and more. The hard part isn't the cadence — it's getting a high-quality, consent-documented source to run them against.

Part V — The Infinity Nurture System

The opener cadence handles the first 14 days. After that, 85–90% of your leads will have not closed. They are not dead — they are **not yet**. Your job is to stay professionally present until they are ready.

This is where most aged-lead operations die. They buy a new list, blow through the opener cadence, and abandon the 85% who didn't close. Then they buy another list.

The math of that is brutal. If you buy 1,000 leads/month and abandon 90% after 14 days, you accumulate zero long-term asset. If you buy 1,000 leads/month and nurture the 90%, after 12 months you have a nurture list of 10,800 prospects — all of whom raised their hand for your product at some point.

A 1% annual close rate on a nurture list of 10,800 is 108 deals, at near-zero marginal cost. That's your second business.

The nurture architecture

After Day 14 (end of opener cadence), every non-closed lead enters one of three buckets:

Bucket 1: Warm — active follow-up, 30-day rhythm

Qualification: Any lead that responded to the opener cadence but didn't close. Includes "call me next month," "I'm thinking about it," "reach out in Q2."

Cadence:

- Week 3 after opener: 1 phone call + 1 text
- Week 5: 1 phone call + 1 email
- Week 7: 1 phone call + 1 text
- Continue at 2-week rhythm for 3 months

Exit criteria:

- Closes: move to customer list
- Opts out: move to suppression

- Goes completely silent for 90 days: demote to Cold (Bucket 2)

Bucket 2: Cold — passive nurture, 90-day rhythm

Qualification: Any lead that didn't respond to the opener cadence and didn't opt out.

Cadence:

- Month 1 after opener: 1 email — "Still thinking about [vertical]?" — soft, no pressure
- Month 3: 1 phone call + 1 email
- Month 6: 1 phone call + 1 text
- Month 9: 1 email with a market update
- Month 12: 1 phone call — "anniversary" call

Exit criteria:

- Responds to any touch: promote to Warm
- Opts out: move to suppression
- No response after 12 months: demote to Dormant (Bucket 3) OR drop entirely

Bucket 3: Dormant — newsletter only

Qualification: Leads that have been through 12+ months of nurture without a response, but haven't opted out.

Cadence:

- Monthly email newsletter — market updates, relevant tips, no direct sell
- No phone calls
- No SMS (SMS consent degrades after long silence — compliance risk)

Exit criteria:

- Unsubscribes: suppression
- Opens/clicks newsletter: promote to Cold
- Replies to newsletter: promote to Warm

The nurture calendar (simplified)

Map every lead to one of these three buckets on Day 14. Then let the calendar run.

Day	Warm	Cold	Dormant
14	Enter bucket	Enter bucket	—
30	Call + text	—	—
45	Call + email	Email (Month 1)	—
60	Call + text	—	—
90	Call + text	Call + email (Month 3)	—
180	Continue 2-wk	Call + text (Month 6)	—
270	—	Email (Month 9)	—
365	—	Anniversary call (Month 12)	Enter bucket / drop
Monthly	—	—	Newsletter

A CRM with cadence automation (Setup B+) makes this effortless. In Setup A (no-tech), you run the calendar in a Google Sheet with conditional-format highlighting.

The nurture content library

Nurture touches are not "just checking in." Every nurture touch should pair a value point with a soft ask. Build a library of nurture content pieces you rotate through:

1. **Market update** — "Rates/premiums/prices did X this quarter"
2. **Common mistake** — "Here's the #1 thing folks who shopped [vertical] 6 months ago regret"
3. **Case study** — "Worked with someone last week in a similar spot — here's how it came out"
4. **Question** — "What's the one thing that would make you ready to look at this again?"
5. **Tool/resource** — "Built a simple calculator for [X] — free, thought you might find it useful"
6. **Seasonal** — Q4 planning, year-end tax, spring shopping, whatever fits your vertical

Rotate through the library so nurture doesn't feel repetitive. A 6-piece library fills 18 months of nurture touches without repetition.

Worksheet 6 — Nurture Calendar. In your workbook, map your current lead base to the three buckets and schedule the first 90 days of nurture touches.

Part VI — Compliance Foundation

This is the shortest part of the playbook and the most important. Skip compliance and you will lose your operation — not to the market, to the regulator.

I am not a lawyer. This is operator guidance, not legal advice. When you have a real question, the firm I trust is Henson Legal — they're the TCPA specialists I call. Budget for a 30-minute intro consult before you run your first campaign. It will be the best $300–$500 you spend on this operation.

The non-negotiables

1. DNC scrubbing — every file, every time

Before any outreach fires, every phone number in your list must be scrubbed against:

- The national DNC registry
- Any state-specific DNC lists applicable to your outreach (several states maintain their own)
- Your internal suppression list (anyone who has asked you to stop)
- The lead publisher's suppression list (if provided)

Scrub cost runs $0.005–$0.02 per number at volume. For a 1,000-lead batch, that's $5–$20. Skip it and the downside is $500–$1,500+ in statutory damages per violation, per call. Do not be clever about this.

2. Consent documentation — keep the record

For every lead, you should be able to produce, on demand:

- The original form the consumer filled out
- The exact consent language they agreed to
- The date/time/IP of the submission
- The source publisher who sold you the data

Reputable aged-lead publishers provide this in a "trusted form certificate" or equivalent. If your publisher won't provide it, shop elsewhere.

On the 1-to-1 consent rule (as of 2026). The FCC's proposed rule that would have required consent to name each specific caller (the "one-to-one" rule) was **vacated by the 11th Circuit in January 2025** (*Insurance Marketing Coalition v. FCC*) and formally repealed by the FCC in August 2025. The earlier "prior express written consent" (PEWC) standard is back in force — which is less prescriptive about buyer-naming, but still requires clear, unambiguous consent for autodialed or prerecorded calls/texts.

What this means practically: inherited aged-lead consent is still workable for manual dial and email. It is **weaker ground for autodialed calls, prerecorded voice, RVM, and automated SMS.** The safest strategy is to *use the aged-lead cadence to earn fresh PEWC directly from each prospect* (see the Fresh-Consent Ladder in Part IV), and run your higher-intensity channels only on fresh-consent records.

3. SMS compliance — 10DLC, opt-out, and hours

- Your SMS sending numbers should be registered with your carrier as 10DLC (10-digit-long-code) with a business profile. Unregistered numbers get blocked and may create carrier-terms-of-service problems.
- Every SMS message — especially the first touch — should include an opt-out mechanism ("Reply STOP to opt out").
- Honor opt-outs immediately. When someone replies STOP, your system should add them to suppression in real time across all channels.
- Federal SMS time windows: 8 AM–9 PM in the **prospect's** local time zone. **Several states cap earlier at 8 PM** — FL, OK, WA, MD, AL, CT, LA, MA, MS, WY.
- **On aged leads specifically:** running automated SMS on inherited consent alone is a higher-risk posture. The conservative approach is Fresh-Consent Ladder Play 2 (text-to-join keyword) — get the prospect to initiate the SMS relationship.

4. Call time windows

The federal TCPA allows calls 8 AM–9 PM in the prospect's local time zone. **Several state mini-TCPAs cap earlier at 8 PM** (see list above). Know your prospect's time zone — infer from area code, confirm with address where available.

State frequency caps:

- **Florida FTSA and Oklahoma OTSA:** no more than **3 calls or texts per 24-hour period on the same subject.** Going over the cap is a statutory violation.
- **Washington HB 1497:** the caller must identify themselves, their company, and the purpose within the first 30 seconds of the call. Must end the call within 10 seconds of the called party

requesting to end it.

Texas updated its telemarketing rules in August 2025 — check current state of play before running Texas lists.

5. Autodialer, predictive dialer, and prerecorded rules

TCPA requires **Prior Express Written Consent (PEWC)** for autodialed or prerecorded calls/texts to cell phones. On aged leads, inherited consent rarely supports this cleanly.

- **Predictive and parallel dialers to cell phones on aged lists:** do not run without a PEWC record from each prospect that explicitly covers automated calls. This is a Mode C tactic in this context.
- **Preview dialers (one-at-a-time, agent-initiated):** generally fine. This is the Mode B default.
- **Ringless voicemail (RVM):** the FCC ruled in November 2022 that RVM to wireless is a "call" under the TCPA and requires consent. **Do not run RVM at scale on inherited aged-lead consent.** It is the fastest way to collect a TCPA demand letter in this vertical.
- **Prerecorded voice calls:** same rules as RVM — require PEWC to cells.

The operating rule: manual or preview dial only, unless your consent workflow produces fresh PEWC directly from each prospect (Fresh-Consent Ladder, Part IV).

6. State-specific rules (as of 2026)

State mini-TCPAs layer on top of federal. The meaningful ones:

State	Framework	Key provisions
Florida (FTSA)	§501.059 + §501.616	PEWC required for automated outreach; 3-calls/day cap; 8 AM–8 PM; $500/call statutory
Oklahoma (OTSA)	eff. Nov 2022	Modeled on FTSA; 3 calls/day; 8 AM–8 PM
Washington (HB 1497)	in force	30-second ID rule; 10-second hang-up rule
Maryland	mini-TCPA	Stricter consent + 8 PM cap
Texas	Updated Aug 2025	Check current state; was historically less strict
California	CCPA/CPRA	Data-handling obligations (not outreach-specific)

If you buy leads in these states, scrub against state DNC, honor state caps, and document consent in the form the state requires. When in doubt, call Henson Legal.

7. Coming in 2027 — revocation-all rule

The FCC's "revocation-all" rule — which requires a single opt-out to apply across all unrelated calls and texts from the same sender — was scheduled for 2026 but has been delayed to **January 31, 2027.** Start building opt-out-propagation infrastructure now so you're ready.

The compliance stack — minimum viable

For Mode A (Conservative):

- DNC scrubber (manual batch): DNC.com, PossibleNOW, or Gryphon — $0.005–$0.02 per number
- Google Sheet suppression list with a dedicated tab
- Henson Legal on call: budget $300–$500 for an initial consult, $200–$400/hour as-needed
- Fresh-Consent Ladder (Part IV) infrastructure — a landing page with PEWC form + 10DLC SMS keyword

For Mode B (Operator Standard):

- All of the above, plus integrated DNC scrubbing in your CRM (HubSpot, Close, GoHighLevel connectors)
- Call recording with "this call may be recorded" disclosure where required
- Automated cross-channel opt-out propagation
- Quarterly compliance audit (Worksheet 8) plus one annual counsel review

The audit cadence

Once a month, audit your operation:

1. Random-sample 10 outreach records. For each: confirm the consent record is on file, confirm DNC scrub happened, confirm suppression check happened, confirm no outreach outside call-time window.
2. Review all opt-outs from the prior month. Confirm each has been suppressed across all channels.
3. Review your DNC scrubber invoice. Confirm every list you outreached got scrubbed.
4. Spot-check SMS records for 10DLC registration status and opt-out inclusion.

Document the audit in a log. When — not if — you get a demand letter, your documented audit history is evidence of good-faith compliance and is very hard to penetrate.

> **Worksheet 8 — Compliance Self-Audit.** In your workbook, run the first month's audit using the checklist provided.

Part VII — The 90-Day Operator Diagnostic

You've read the playbook. Now let's find out where your operation actually stands.

This diagnostic has 25 questions across 5 dimensions. Score each question 0–4 (0 = not doing this at all, 4 = doing this consistently and well). Total score out of 100.

Dimension 1: Unit economics (20 points)

1. I know my current ARPC within $50 of accuracy. (0–4)
2. I know my current contact rate per lead source. (0–4)
3. I know my current contact-to-close rate. (0–4)
4. I compute my max viable CPL before every lead purchase. (0–4)
5. I review my unit economics at least monthly. (0–4)

Dimension 2: Operation setup (20 points)

6. I have a defined tech stack matched to my volume. (0–4)
7. I have named the 5 operational roles and know who owns each. (0–4)
8. I have a documented lead-intake process (scrub, segment, tag). (0–4)
9. I have a CRM or sheet that tracks every touch with every lead. (0–4)
10. I know what my bottleneck is right now. (0–4)

Dimension 3: Outreach discipline (20 points)

11. I run a defined multi-channel 14-day opener cadence. (0–4)
12. My scripts are written down and refreshed quarterly. (0–4)
13. I log every touch with outcome. (0–4)
14. I vary call times and days to improve contact rate. (0–4)
15. My break-up touches are as intentional as my first touches. (0–4)

Dimension 4: Nurture (20 points)

16. I have a 30/60/90/180/365-day nurture calendar. (0–4)
17. I classify every non-closed lead into Warm/Cold/Dormant. (0–4)

18. I have a library of 6+ nurture content pieces I rotate through. (0–4)
19. I track re-engagement rate on nurture touches. (0–4)
20. I have closed at least one deal from a 90+ day old lead in the last quarter. (0–4)

Dimension 5: Compliance (20 points)

21. I scrub every list against DNC before outreach. (0–4)
22. I have consent documentation archived for every lead in my system. (0–4)
23. My SMS operation is 10DLC-registered with opt-out on every message. (0–4)
24. I honor opt-outs within 24 hours across all channels. (0–4)
25. I run a monthly compliance audit and document it. (0–4)

Scoring

- **85–100:** You are running at an operator level. Focus on marginal optimization.
- **65–84:** You have the basics right. Focus on your lowest-scoring dimension.
- **40–64:** Workable but leaking. Pick the two dimensions with the lowest scores and fix those this quarter.
- **Below 40:** You are running on feel. Stop buying leads until you install the basics. You're losing money on every purchase.

> **Worksheet 10 — Operator Diagnostic.** In your workbook, complete the 25-question diagnostic and identify your top 2 weak dimensions.

Next moves

You now have the system. The difference between operators who succeed with aged leads and those who don't is not knowledge — it's execution.

Here's what to do this week:

1. **Fill out the workbook.** All 10 worksheets. It will take 90 minutes. Do it once, reference it forever.
2. **Score yourself on the diagnostic.** Be honest. The diagnostic is only useful if you're honest about where you are today.

3. **Pick one dimension to fix in the next 30 days.** Not five. One. Usually it's either the unit economics (you don't know your numbers) or the outreach cadence (you're not following one).
4. **Find a lead source.** When you're ready to buy, **agedleadstore.com** offers aged leads across all the major verticals with consent documentation and suppression support. Start with the smallest batch they offer, run it through your new system, and measure.
5. **Get on the weekly list.** The Aged Lead Sales weekly newsletter ships every Tuesday with one tactical idea to sharpen your operation. You're already on the list (that's how you got this playbook). Open every one — they're short.

You have the system. Go run it.

— Bill

The Aged Lead Operator's System is published by Aged Lead Sales. For corrections, updates, or to request a vertical-specific consultation, visit agedleadsales.com/contact.

Mortgage Overlay

Mortgage Overlay — Aged Mortgage Leads

Companion to The Aged Lead Operator's System. Read the master playbook first.

This overlay gives you mortgage-specific scripts, benchmarks, compliance notes, and objections — tuned to aged refi, purchase, HELOC, and reverse-mortgage leads.

> **Compliance mode reminder.** Default to Mode A (manual dial, plain-text email, fresh-consent ladder) for inherited aged-lead consent. Graduate specific prospects to Mode B (SMS, automation) only after you've captured fresh PEWC from them directly. The mortgage vertical has above-average TCPA plaintiff activity — stay in Mode A until your consent workflow is rock-solid.
>
> **Recommended counsel:** Henson Legal for any TCPA, state mini-TCPA, or UDAAP question.

Vertical benchmarks

Metric	Realistic range (aged, 60–180 days)
CPL	$0.75–$5.00
Contact rate	10–18%
Contact-to-application	5–12%
Contact-to-funded	2–6%
ARPC (LO commission)	$1,500–$5,000
ARPC (branch owner / company)	$3,000–$10,000+
Break-even CPL (at 12% contact, 4% close, $2,500 ARPC, 4× return)	$3.00

Implication. At $2,500 ARPC and 4× target return, your max CPL is ~$3. If you're paying more than that on aged mortgage leads, the economics require above-average execution on cadence and scripts. Above-average is achievable — but go in with eyes open.

> **Where to source aged mortgage leads.**
>
> AgedLeadStore offers aged refi, purchase, HELOC, and reverse-mortgage leads with documented TCPA consent — sortable by age, geography, and credit segment, with batches starting at 100 leads.
>
> **Shop aged mortgage leads →**

Product splits — how to work different mortgage lead types

Not all mortgage inquiries are the same. The same prospect, 90 days ago, with a different product need, requires a different pitch.

Refi leads

Prospect intent: rate savings, cash-out, shorter term, debt consolidation.

Best pitch angle: what's changed in the market since they shopped. Rate movement, new product availability, LLPA changes, cash-out availability.

Hottest sub-segments:

- Prospects who shopped when rates were higher — market has moved in their favor
- Cash-out shoppers — equity has grown, needs have often sharpened
- ARM holders approaching reset dates

Purchase leads

Prospect intent: pre-approval, locking in, first-time buyer questions.

Best pitch angle: where are they in the house hunt, and what's their timeline. Aged purchase leads frequently have either (a) not bought and are still shopping, or (b) bought and need a refi in 6 months.

Hottest sub-segments:

- Pre-approval shoppers who never closed on a home (still actively hunting)
- Recent closers (3–6 months post-close) now shopping rate/term refis
- First-time buyer education leads — long nurture potential

HELOC leads

Prospect intent: home equity access — renovation, debt consolidation, investment.

Best pitch angle: product comparisons (HELOC vs cash-out refi vs HELoan), and rate movement on prime-linked products.

Sub-segment note: HELOC shoppers are often comparison shoppers. If they didn't close 3 months ago, there's usually a specific reason — probably rate, LTV, or documentation. Diagnose fast.

Reverse / senior products

Prospect intent: income supplementation, medical bills, aging in place.

Best pitch angle: education-first. Aged reverse leads are often nervous prospects who scared themselves out of closing. Re-open the conversation with education, not urgency.

Compliance note: reverse mortgage marketing has elevated disclosure requirements. Know your state's rules before making specific product claims in calls or SMS.

Mortgage-specific scripts

Script MA1 — First-touch call (live pickup), refi angle

> "Hey [Name], this is [Your Name] with [Company]. A couple months back you looked at refinancing your mortgage — rates have moved since then, and I wanted to see if you're still thinking about it or if you got it handled."

If they ask "how did rates move":

> "30-year fixed is down about [current vs their shop date — check Freddie Mac PMMS]. Depending on your current rate, that could mean [specific dollar range of monthly savings] or cash out [dollar range] if that's something you'd want to look at. Want me to run your numbers real quick?"

Have the market rate data in front of you before every call. Two tabs: Freddie Mac PMMS for 30-year trend, Mortgage News Daily for intraday.

Script MA2 — First-touch voicemail, refi

> "Hey [Name], [Your Name] with [Company]. Calling about the refi question you looked at back in [month]. Rates moved about [current vs shop-date delta] since then — wanted to see if that changes anything for you. Give me a ring at [number] or I'll try you in a couple days."

Script MA3 — Purchase angle

> "Hey [Name], [Your Name] with [Company]. You looked at pre-approval back in [month] — just checking in to see if you're still house hunting or if you closed on something already."

If still hunting: "What's the holdup — market, inventory, rate, or something else on your side?" — and actually listen.

If they already closed: "Congrats. Quick question — what rate did you end up with? Depending on what it was, it might be worth keeping an eye on a refi window 6–12 months out. Happy to stay in touch if useful."

That second branch is gold. Recent closers convert to refis at 15–25% over 2 years. Every aged purchase lead who already closed should go straight into your Cold nurture bucket.

Script MA4 — HELOC angle

> "Hey [Name], [Your Name] with [Company]. You looked at a HELOC back in [month] — wanted to see if you got the equity thing handled, or if it's still on your list."

Probe for why they didn't close: rate? LTV cap? Documentation? Whatever the reason, address it directly or refer them to a different product if your shop has it.

Mortgage objection library

"Rates are too high." → "Totally hear you. What rate would make it worth looking at again?" Get the number. Use it to decide whether to nurture or exit.

"I already locked with someone." → "Did you close, or just lock?" If locked-not-closed, ask if the loan is in underwriting and if there's been any rate/appraisal/income drama. 10–15% of locked loans die in UW and the prospect needs a Plan B.

"I don't want to restart the process." → "Fair — most of the pain is front-loaded, and you already did that part six months ago. Your old documents are probably still good. Want me to pull a quick estimate without putting you through another full application?"

"Send me the numbers, I'll look at them." → "Happy to — real quick, what's your current rate and roughly what's left on the loan? I can have a 30-second number over to you in the next hour, and then we can decide from there." Aged leads who never get a number will never re-engage. Get the data point on the call.

Mortgage SMS scripts

Script MS1 — Post-voicemail, refi

> "Hey [Name] — [Your Name] with [Company]. Just left you a VM on your refi question — rates moved about [delta] since you looked. Worth a 5-min call? Reply STOP to opt out."

Script MS2 — Value-first, refi

> "Hey [Name] — quick note: 30-yr fixed is down [delta] from when you shopped. On a $[loan size estimate based on demographics] loan that's about $[monthly savings estimate]/month. Want me to run your exact numbers? Reply STOP to opt out."

If you can pull the loan size from the lead data, personalize. If not, use a conservative mid-range estimate.

Script MS3 — Break-up, mortgage

> "Hey [Name] — I've reached out a few times on your mortgage question. If now's not the right time, all good — reply back when you're ready and I'll pick it up. Reply STOP to opt out."

Mortgage email scripts

Script ME1 — Day 2 opener email, refi

Subject: Your refi question from [month]

> Hey [Name],
>
> Back in [month] you looked at refinancing. I ended up with that inquiry on my desk and wanted to check in.
>
> Quick heads-up on what's changed since you shopped:
>
> - 30-year fixed is at ~[current rate]% (was ~[rate at shop time]%)
> - [Any LLPA / program / guideline change relevant to the month they shopped]
>
> If you're still weighing it, I can run your numbers and send back a clean estimate — usually takes me less than 30 minutes. If you already closed, just reply "handled" and I'll close my file.
>
> — Bill [NMLS #, phone]

Script ME2 — Day 5 value email

Subject: One thing I'd double-check on your refi

> [Name] —
>
> Most folks who shopped a refi 3+ months ago fall into one of three buckets:
>
> 1. Rates were too high — now they may have moved
> 2. They didn't like the closing cost — now lender credits are different
> 3. Their credit or income situation wasn't ready — now it might be
>
> Which one was it for you? I can usually tell you in 5 minutes whether the answer has changed.
>
> — Bill

Script ME3 — Purchase follow-up, closed-not-refied branch

If the prospect closed on a home and isn't yet ready for a refi, this goes in Cold nurture on a 6-month timer:

Subject: Checking in on [address or general area]

> [Name],
>
> Saw you closed on a house a few months back — hope it's all been going well.
>
> Quick note: rates have moved since then, and depending on what you locked at, it might be worth a 5-min check to see if there's anything to squeeze out of a refi. No pressure, just a pulse check.
>
> Good to schedule something, or better if I circle back in a few months?
>
> — Bill

Compliance notes specific to mortgage

Loan officer disclosure

Every outbound mortgage call you make typically needs to disclose your NMLS ID. Requirements vary by state — some require oral disclosure on the first call, others allow written-only in follow-up. Know your state rules.

Safe default: on first-live-pickup call, say your name, NMLS ID, and company name in the opener. "[Your Name], NMLS [number], with [Company]."

TILA / RESPA

Any specific rate or payment quote you give triggers disclosure obligations downstream. Be precise — if you're giving an illustrative range, call it a range and note it's subject to full qualification. Never commit to a rate on a cold call.

UDAAP

The CFPB's Unfair, Deceptive, or Abusive Acts or Practices rule applies hardest to mortgage. Marketing language that implies urgency where there isn't any ("rates are about to explode" on a quiet day), promises that aren't universally true, or pressure tactics on elderly prospects can all produce UDAAP claims. Be calm, be accurate, and stay away from hyperbole.

State-specific mortgage marketing rules

Several states have specific rules on mortgage solicitations:

- **Texas** — restrictions on certain types of mortgage mailers and communications
- **California** — CRMLA-specific advertising rules, including prominent display of license info
- **New York** — restrictions on "lowest rate" claims unless substantiated

If you're outbound-calling in these states, get your marketing materials and scripts reviewed by a mortgage-savvy attorney.

Consent and SMS — current state (2026)

The FCC's proposed 1-to-1 consent rule — which would have required inherited consent to name each specific caller — was **vacated by the 11th Circuit in January 2025** and formally repealed by the FCC in August 2025. The pre-existing "prior express written consent" (PEWC) standard is back in force.

What this means practically for mortgage aged leads:

- Manual dial + voicemail + plain-text email on inherited consent is generally workable.
- Automated SMS on inherited consent alone is weaker ground. **Best practice: run the Fresh-Consent Ladder (master playbook, Part IV) to earn direct SMS consent from each prospect before escalating to text.**
- On new purchases, still ask your publisher to confirm consent records are PEWC-quality. A good trusted-form certificate should name the consumer, the form language, the timestamp, and the permitted contact channels.

Mortgage-specific fresh-consent plays

Mortgage prospects respond to a few specific fresh-consent lures. Use these inside your 14-day cadence to graduate inherited-consent leads into owned, fresh-consent leads:

1. **Rate-alert opt-in** — "Want me to text you when rates move 0.25% or more? Free, no pitches — just the alert. Text RATE to [keyword number] to join." This converts well because rate-sensitive

prospects actually want the data.

2. **Payment-calculator landing page** — Your callback landing page offers a simple payment calculator that returns a number after the prospect submits name/phone/email with a PEWC checkbox. High conversion because it pairs value with consent.
3. **Loan-doc checklist download** — "Text DOCS to [keyword number] and I'll send you the list of everything you need for a refi application" — low-commitment, high intent signal.
4. **Closing-cost estimate** — Gate behind a PEWC form. "Tell me your loan balance and current rate and I'll send a real closing-cost range in 5 minutes."

DNC and state mortgage DNCs

Several states maintain separate mortgage-solicitation DNC lists layered on top of federal. Florida FTSA layers heavily on top of federal — 8 AM–8 PM, 3 calls/texts per day per subject, $500/call statutory. Oklahoma OTSA is similar. Scrub against federal AND state before any mortgage-specific outreach.

> **When in doubt:** Henson Legal. A short consult before you run your first list is cheaper than one TCPA demand letter.

Mortgage-specific nurture content

Build your nurture library around mortgage-relevant value points:

- Weekly rate update (Freddie Mac PMMS Thursday release)
- Cash-out equity calculator link
- Tax-season content (mortgage interest deduction, points)
- Year-end planning (if the prospect had a variable-rate product, ARM reset content)
- Purchase-season content (spring buying market, rate locks, earnest money tactics)
- Refi-boom content (when rates drop meaningfully, reach out to *everyone* in your Cold bucket)

Trigger-based touches. When Freddie Mac PMMS moves more than 0.25% in a month, send a one-off market update to every Cold + Dormant lead. Keep the language factual, not promotional. This is your highest-conversion nurture touch in mortgage.

Your mortgage operator quick-check

Before running your first aged mortgage campaign:

- ☐ Max viable CPL calculated with your ARPC, 4× return target
- ☐ NMLS disclosure language in all scripts
- ☐ State-specific DNC scrub set up for any state in the file
- ☐ SMS consent verified with publisher
- ☐ Market-rate tab open during all calls (Freddie Mac + Mortgage News Daily)
- ☐ Cash-out and term-reduction calculators bookmarked
- ☐ 14-day opener cadence loaded in CRM or sheet
- ☐ Nurture library pre-built with 6+ mortgage-specific touches

You're ready. Go.

Your first batch.

Start with 500–1,000 aged mortgage leads so you have enough volume to measure contact and conversion rates meaningfully. Don't buy your max-CPL — start at 50–70% of it to prove the system, then scale.

Browse aged mortgage leads →
